

**ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)**  
**ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION**  
**O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE**

**ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/1**

**PAPER 1 November 2023**

**1 hour 30 minutes**

**PAPER 1 — COMPOSITION — 50 MARKS — 1 HOUR 30 MINUTES**

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2023 1122/1.

**Additional materials:** Answer booklet. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

**INSTRUCTIONS:** Answer one question from Section A (30 marks, 350–450 words) and the compulsory question in Section B (20 marks). Mistakes in spelling, punctuation and grammar may be penalised.

**SECTION A (30 marks) — Answer ONE question · 350–450 words**

1. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Write a story that begins: “The last candle went out and the house seemed to listen.”</b> **[30]**
2. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Forgiveness</b> **[30]**
3. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Explain how young people can protect themselves from drug abuse.</b> **[30]**
4. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Write a story that ends: “...I finally understood what my grandmother had meant.”</b> **[30]**
5. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>“Homework is a waste of time.” How far do you agree?</b> **[30]**
6. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Write about the joys and difficulties of being the eldest child.</b> **[30]**
7. Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between 350 and 450 words. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>><b>Describe an old relative’s kitchen on a Sunday morning.</b> **[30]**

**SECTION B (20 marks) — Answer the following question · compulsory**

- 8.** Answer the following question. Begin your answer on a fresh page. <<<BR>>><<<BR>>> You bought a school bag that tore within a week. Write a letter of complaint to the shop manager. <<<BR>>> Include: <<<BR>>> • when and where you bought it (invent reasonable details) <<<BR>>> • the fault <<<BR>>> • what you have already done <<<BR>>> • whether you want a replacement or a refund. **[20]**

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).